ShiftLoop — research findings

Task 1 · UI/UX Design & Product Design · Sumerix Global

Eswar Mahalingam · Batch 15 Oct 2026 · 36 weeks

The problem

Night- and evening-shift team leads at gateway hubs need a fast, structured way to hand over pending loads, exceptions, safety and equipment status to the incoming lead, because today that information is scattered across WhatsApp groups, paper registers and verbal briefings — so items are missed, nobody can prove who acknowledged a safety risk, and the next shift starts by firefighting instead of planning.

HMW let a tired team lead capture a complete handover in under 5 minutes — even without network?

Why it matters

Logistics cost in India: **7.8–8.9% of GDP** (NCAER 2023). Hub efficiency compounds across thousands of shifts.

Shift handover is a recognised human-factors risk (UK HSE). Missed safety flags have real consequences.

Research plan

Survey
12 questions · 15 responses across 3 shifts

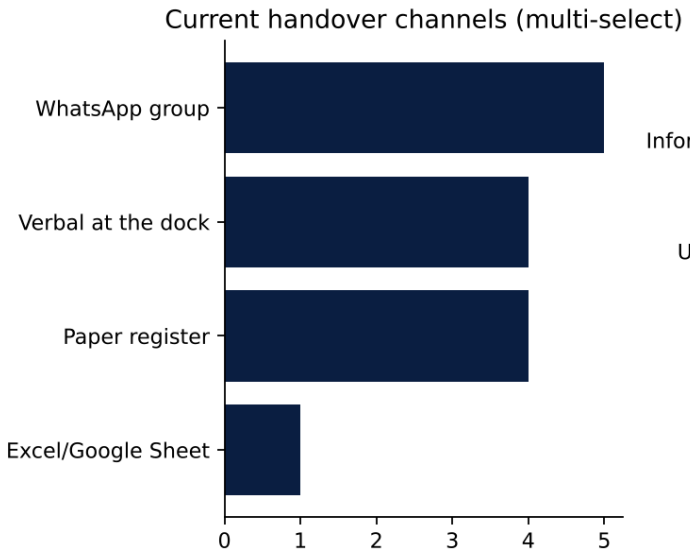
Interviews
5 × 30 min · leads, associate, hub manager

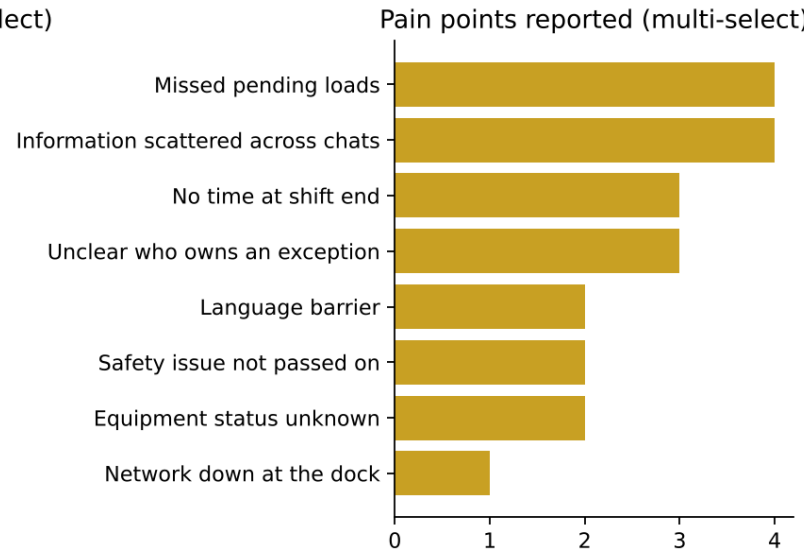
Observation
3 live handovers · timing & tools

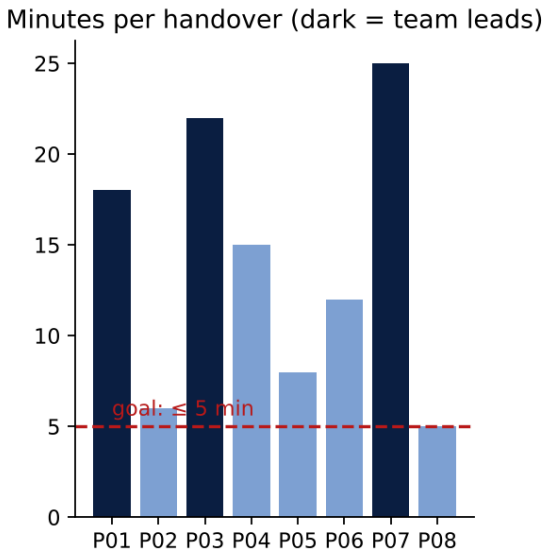
Pilot charts use DECLARED SYNTHETIC data — replaced by real responses before conclusions.

Pilot analysis pipeline

PILOT DATA — DECLARED SYNTHETIC (n = 8). Replace with real survey responses before drawing conclusions.







Competitor landscape

Competitor analysis — shift handover at a logistics hub

Heuristic review against the brief's criteria. Ratings are the designer's assessment of public product pages and store listings (Nov 2026) — validate hands-on during interviews.

Criterion	Connecteam	Deputy	Microsoft Teams — Shifts	Status quo: WhatsApp group + paper register
Primary job	All-in-one frontline app: scheduling, time clock, checklists/forms, chat	Scheduling, timesheets and labour cost	Rosters and shift swaps inside Teams	Free-form chat + handwritten log
Navigation	4/5 Tab bar + module hub; many modules to discover	4/5 Clear schedule-first navigation	3/5 Lives inside Teams; several taps to reach Shifts	2/5 Chronological chat only; no structure
Layout & visual hierarchy	4/5 Card-based, configurable	4/5 Clean calendar/timeline views	3/5 Dense Office styling	1/5 Wall of messages; important items scroll away
Search	3/5 Search inside modules	3/5 People/shift search	4/5 Teams search across chats/files	2/5 Keyword search in chat; register not searchable
'Checkout' = handover sign-off	3/5 Possible via custom checklist/form; not hub-specific	2/5 No dedicated handover template found on public pages	2/5 Notes per shift; no structured acknowledgement	1/5 No sign-off, no owner, no timestamp
Offline use at the dock	3/5 Varies by module	3/5 Some offline features	2/5 Needs connectivity for most actions	4/5 Paper always works; chat queues
Accessibility & language	4/5 Multiple languages; readable type	3/5 Good contrast; limited Indian languages	4/5 Office accessibility tooling	3/5 Familiar UI; voice notes help low-literacy users
Overall UX for a hub handover	3/5 Powerful but generic — needs set-up per site	2/5 Strong for rostering, weak for operational context	2/5 Fits office teams better than floor teams	2/5 Fast to start, fails on accountability

Strengths & weaknesses

Product	Strengths	Weaknesses / opportunity for ShiftLoop
Connecteam	Checklists, forms, chat and scheduling in one app; frontline focus	Generic forms → each hub must design its own handover; can feel heavy for associates
Deputy	Mature scheduling, compliance and timesheet flows	Handover context (pending loads, exceptions, dock status) is outside its core model
MS Teams — Shifts	Already in many enterprises; strong identity & search	Office-centric UI; floor staff rarely live in Teams; weak offline story
WhatsApp + register	Zero training, works on any phone, voice notes	No structure, no ownership, no audit trail; safety items get buried

Design opportunity: none of the options combines a hub-specific checklist, explicit owner + acknowledgement, offline-first capture and voice/photo evidence in one 5-minute flow.

Personas

DK

Divya Krishnan

29 · Night-shift Team Lead · Gateway hub, Coimbatore

"By 5:45 I'm fighting three fires. The handover is the last thing I want to type into WhatsApp."

Digital confidence

Time pressure

Need for accountability

Proto-persona: built from secondary research and the designer's floor experience; validate with ≥ 5 interviews.

GOALS

- Close the shift with zero surprises for the morning lead
- Prove her team hit SLA despite late linehauls
- Spend < 5 minutes on handover

PAIN POINTS

- Pending loads and exceptions scattered across 4 WhatsApp groups
- Network drops inside the dock
- No record of who acknowledged a safety flag
- Types everything twice (register + chat)

TECHNOLOGY USAGE

Mid-range Android, WhatsApp power user, basic Excel, uses voice notes in Tamil and English

MOTIVATION

Recognition as a reliable lead; promotion to hub manager

DIGITAL SKILLS

Medium — confident with apps she uses daily, avoids long forms

RI

Rajesh Iyer

44 · Hub Manager · accountable for 3 shifts and SLA

"When a bag is missed at 8 a.m., I need to know in one minute what the night shift knew."

Digital confidence

Time pressure

Need for accountability

Proto-persona: built from secondary research and the designer's floor experience; validate with ≥ 5 interviews.

GOALS

- Audit trail of every handover and exception
- Spot recurring issues (docks, equipment) across weeks
- Fewer escalations from customers and linehaul partners

PAIN POINTS

- Reconstructs incidents from chat screenshots
- Cannot compare shifts objectively
- Safety issues reported late

TECHNOLOGY USAGE

Laptop + Android, Excel/Power BI dashboards, email-heavy

MOTIVATION

Hub ranking, zero safety incidents

DIGITAL SKILLS

High — comfortable with dashboards and reports

Empathy map — Divya at handover

DK

Divya · Night-shift Team Lead

at shift handover (05:30–06:15)

THINKS

- “If I miss this, the morning shift will blame my team.”
- “Typing a long message now will delay dispatch.”
- “Did anyone even read my safety note?”

FEELS

- Pressured in the last 30 minutes of the shift
- Anxious about un-owned exceptions
- Proud when the next shift starts clean

SAYS

- “Check the group, I posted it.”
- “Bag 4471 is pending — tell Arun.”
- “Forklift on D7 is down again.”

DOES

- Sends 10–20 WhatsApp messages and voice notes
- Writes a short note in the paper register
- Walks the docks for a last check, phone in hand

PAIN POINTS

- Information scattered across chats and paper
- No acknowledgement or owner
- Network drops inside the dock
- Same data typed twice

GAINS

- Handover done in < 5 minutes
- Proof that every critical item was acknowledged
- Fewer calls after going home
- Recognition for clean shifts

Goals & success metrics

Type	Goal	Metric
User goal	Complete a handover in ≤ 5 min (median)	Timed in usability test & app analytics
User goal	Incoming lead knows every open item before the first truck	≥ 95% critical items acknowledged within 15 min
Business goal	Fewer missed pending loads / SLA breaches caused by handover gaps	−50% handover-related misses in 8-week pilot
Business goal	Auditable safety communication	100% of safety flags carry owner + acknowledgement
Product goal	Adoption by floor leads	≥ 80% of shifts in the pilot hub use ShiftLoop by week 4
Experience goal	Trust in received information	Trust score (Q9) from ≤ 2.5 → ≥ 4.0 on a 5-point scale

Recommended direction

- Offline-first 6-section handover checklist, pre-filled from scans
- Photo + voice evidence for exceptions
- Explicit acknowledgement by the incoming lead, with escalation
- Manager audit trail without double typing

Next: IA, user flows, card sort & wireframes (Task 2)